



Setting up return rules and return policy

Return rules determine when customers can request returns and how return fees are applied to your store. To allow customers to request returns, you need to [turn on self-serve returns in your online store](#). You can also create a [written return and refund policy](#).

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Understanding return rules

You can set up return rules that are automatically applied to an order when customers place their orders. An order's return rules then apply when customers request returns from your store. An estimated refund is displayed for your customers based on your return rules.

Customers can submit return requests only for items that are eligible under the rules that you set up. This lets you have more control over return requests and prevents your customers from requesting returns for items that aren't eligible based on your return policy.

You can create a return only for fulfilled items. If you refund an unfulfilled order, then the restocking fee isn't displayed. The restocking fee displays only if it's set up and you create a return for a fulfilled order. For more information, refer to [Creating and processing returns and exchanges](#).

Your default return rules apply to most items and include the following types of return rules:

- return window
- return shipping costs
- restocking fee

You can also define final sale items that are exceptions to your default return rules. ▲

You can set up only one set of return rules for each of your stores. Different rules for different markets aren't supported.

Return rules apply to all orders, including B2B orders. B2B customers and staff members for company locations can submit return requests. You can't apply separate return rules to specific order types.

Self-serve returns

Self-serve returns need to be turned on to use return rules. This lets your customers request returns from their accounts, where eligible items and return fees are displayed.

You don't need self-serve returns activated for return rules to be used in your store, or for rules such as restocking fees to apply when you process returns manually from the Shopify admin. Even if self-serve returns are deactivated, return rules still apply when you process returns manually.

Plan requirement

To use return rules with Shopify POS, you need [Shopify POS Pro](#).

Return window

Select a preset return window, or enter a custom number of days. You can select one of the following options:

- 14 days
- 30 days
- 90 days
- Unlimited
- Custom days

The return window starts on the item's delivery date. If the delivery date is unavailable, then the return window starts on the item's fulfillment date and a buffer period is applied to allow for transit time.

Return policies on the Shop app

Early access

Return policy information on Shop app product pages is an early access feature.

When customers view your products on the Shop app, details of your return policy might be displayed on the product page. For example, if you've set a 30-day return window, then this might be displayed to customers alongside shipping details on the product listing.

The return window information comes from the settings that you configure in the [Policies](#) section of your Shopify admin. If you don't set a return window, or if your return policy is written only as free text without a configured return window, then the details of your return policy won't be displayed on Shop app product pages.

Return shipping costs

You can choose how you handle return shipping costs by selecting one of the following options:

- Offer free return shipping.
- Add a flat rate return shipping fee that's charged one time per return.
- Have your customers buy their own return shipping label.

The return shipping fee is displayed when you create a return. You can edit the return shipping fee for a specific return.

Restocking fee

Choose whether you want to charge a restocking fee that is a percentage of the return. If you activate the restocking fee, then it's displayed when customers request a return.

The restocking fee is displayed when you create a return. You can edit the restocking fee for a specific return, including by item.

Return fees aren't automatically deducted from refunds. When you create a refund, you need to manually deduct any applicable return fees.

Final sale items

You can choose which products or collections aren't eligible for returns as final sale items. Your customers can't submit return requests for final sale items. Examples of final sale items might be products that can't be returned, such as perishable, custom, or personal care items, or items with large discounts.

You can add multiple products or multiple collections to the final sale item exceptions, but you can't add both products and collections.

Note

Changes to your return rules apply only to future orders. Changes don't apply to previous orders, so that they don't impact customers who've already placed an order.

Set up return rules

1. From your Shopify admin, go to **Settings** > [Policies](#).

2. In the **Return rules** section, click **Manage**.
3. In the **Return window** section, select how much time a customer has to request a return after an order has been delivered.
4. In the **Return shipping cost** section, select how you want to handle return shipping fees. If you chose to charge a flat rate for return shipping, then enter your flat rate.
5. Optional: To charge a restocking fee, select **Charge restocking fee** and then add a percentage.
6. Optional: To select collections or products that aren't eligible for returns as final sale items, complete the following steps:
 - a. In the **Final sale items** section, select **Specific collections** or **Specific products**.
 - b. Click **Add final sale item** or **Add final sale collection** to add final sale products or collections.
 - c. Select collections, products, or product variants, and then click **Add**.
7. Click **Save**.
8. Click **Turn on**.

Create a written return and refund policy

You can also add or generate a written return and refund policy for your store. You can use HTML in the content of your store policies. The generated policy doesn't automatically include the return rules that you set up.

You can generate a return and refund policy template only in English and for checkouts that are set to English language. If you operate your store in another language, then you can't insert the default template and instead need to create your own policy. Contact a local law expert for help.

Although you can generate a template policy, you're responsible for following your published policy. Review your policy carefully before adding it.

Steps:

1. From your Shopify admin, go to **Settings** > **Policies** [↗](#).
2. In the **Written policies** section, click **Return and refund policy**.
3. Enter your store's return and refund policy, or click **Insert template** to generate the default template. Use the **rich text editor** to add style and formatting to your policy, and to add links and images.
4. Review your return and refund policy and make any changes.
5. Click **Save** to publish your return and refund policy.

After you add your return and refund policy, it's automatically displayed in the footer of your checkout pages. Customers might need to view your policies before they check out, so you can also [link your return and refund policy in your store menu](#).

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